

Sunday, 28 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 25° 19°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 23° 16°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 22° 16°	GLASGOW Light rain 18° 14°
-------------------------------	-----------------------------------	--	----------------------------------

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The Home Secretary has announced a new refugee sponsorship route into the UK, aiming to restore confidence in the asylum system.

James Mahmood says these 'capped safe and legal' routes will offer a structured approach for people seeking refuge. It marks a significant policy development in the ongoing debate around immigration.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

Hundreds of flights at Heathrow and Gatwick have faced significant delays, largely due to severe thunderstorms south of the UK.

More than 800 flights were affected at the two major airports. Travellers are advised to check with their airlines for the latest information before heading out.

TRAVEL · UK
- 3

A UK search and rescue team has joined the international effort following a devastating earthquake in Venezuela.

The 68-strong team departed from Brize Norton airbase on Friday, onboard an RAF plane carrying vital aid supplies. They will be assisting with rescue operations and providing humanitarian support.

WORLD NEWS · UK
- 4

Britain has experienced its hottest June day on record for the third consecutive day, with temperatures soaring to 37.3 degrees Celsius in Suffolk.

The intense heatwave has gripped much of the country, although forecasters predict a slight easing over the weekend. Many will be looking forward to a cooler change.

WEATHER · UK
- 5

Prince Harry and Meghan, the Duchess of Sussex, have accepted an offer to stay at a royal estate during their upcoming visit to the UK.

While the specific residence hasn't been disclosed, the couple will also be using private accommodation during their trip. It marks another return to the UK for the Duke and Duchess.

ROYAL · UK

What's coming up

1 **Madonna has dropped a huge hint about a potential Glastonbury appearance, alongside other revelations, in her recent Graham Norton interview.**

The Queen of Pop reportedly shared details about her career and personal life. Fans are now buzzing with speculation about what she might have planned.

ON AIR – Would you love to see Madonna perform at Glastonbury? What's your favourite Madonna track?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **Just two years ago, she was delivering Amazon parcels, and now this R&B singer is an international star!**

Her breakout single, 'Worst Behaviour,' was initially sold on a custom-built website. It's an incredible rags-to-riches story for the music world.

ON AIR – What an amazing turnaround! Who are some other stars who had unexpected jobs before making it big?

MUSIC · NOW

3 **The cast of the groundbreaking LGBT dating show 'Love Island USA' are calling its final season 'bittersweet'.**

They've reflected on the show's significant impact since it first aired. It's been praised for its representation and helping to normalise LGBT relationships on screen.

ON AIR – Did you watch 'Love Island USA'? What impact do you think shows like this have?

TV · NOW

4 **Missing Glastonbury this year? Don't worry, there's a festival happening on your doorstep this weekend!**

Stars like Fatboy Slim and Becky Hill are set to play smaller, local venues across the UK. It's a fantastic way to celebrate the British music scene.

ON AIR – Are you heading to any local festivals this weekend? Who are you most looking forward to seeing?

MUSIC · THIS WEEKEND

5 **Canada could soon be eligible to join the Eurovision Song Contest, according to Prime Minister Mark Carney.**

He raised the idea in his 2025 budget, sparking excitement among fans. It would certainly add a new dimension to the iconic competition.

ON AIR – What do you think about Canada joining Eurovision? Which other countries would you like to see compete?

TV · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **Emma Raducanu's Wimbledon fitness is now in serious doubt after she cut short her practice session on Saturday.**

The British star's chances of being fully fit for the tournament are looking increasingly precarious. Fans will be hoping for a swift recovery ahead of the Grand Slam.

ON AIR – How crucial is Emma Raducanu's fitness for Wimbledon? Do you think she can still make a strong run?
TENNIS · UK

2 **England have lost three early wickets on day three of the third Test against New Zealand at Trent Bridge.**

Joe Root, Jacob Bethell, and Jamie Smith were all dismissed for just eleven runs. It's been a challenging start for the home side as they look to build a lead.

ON AIR – What do England need to do to recover from this shaky start? Who do you think will be the key player today?
CRICKET · UK

3 **Jamie George has criticised his Saracens teammate Totoa Auvaa's 'unacceptable' behaviour after a nightclub incident involving England cricketers.**

Auvaa was reportedly involved in an altercation with England captain Ben Stokes and bowler Gus Atkinson. George's comments highlight the seriousness of the situation.

ON AIR – How important is it for professional athletes to maintain good behaviour off the field? What are your thoughts on this incident?
RUGBY · UK

4 **England's World Cup campaign continues as they face Panama in their final Group L fixture.**

BBC Sport has been analysing the key Panamanian players who will be aiming to cause an upset. England will be looking for a strong performance to secure their position.

ON AIR – What are your predictions for England's match against Panama? How far do you think England will go in the World Cup?
FOOTBALL · UK

5 **Luke Humphries has beaten Luke Littler in a deciding leg to defend his US Darts Masters title in New York.**

It was a thrilling final between the two darts stars, with Humphries ultimately coming out on top. The rivalry between them continues to captivate fans.

ON AIR – What a match between the two Lukes! Who is your favourite darts player and why?
DARTS · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent study found that listening to certain types of music can significantly improve plant growth.**
Researchers observed that plants exposed to classical music, or even soft jazz, showed faster development and stronger stems than those in silence. It seems our leafy friends appreciate a good tune too!
- 2 The trend of 'library lending' for unusual items is gaining traction across the UK.**
Beyond books, some libraries are now offering tools, baking equipment, and even art supplies for loan, encouraging sharing and reducing waste in local communities.
- 3 More people are discovering the meditative benefits of 'forest bathing', or 'shinrin-yoku' as it's known in Japan.**
This practice involves immersing oneself in the atmosphere of the forest, using all five senses to connect with nature, and is said to reduce stress and improve well-being.
- 4 The humble 'teatowel' is having a moment, with designers creating artistic and personalised versions.**
No longer just for drying dishes, these decorative linens are becoming a popular way to add a touch of personality and charm to British kitchens.
- 5 A surge in popularity for 'community gardening projects' is bringing neighbours closer together.**
Shared plots and green spaces are not only producing fresh produce but also cultivating new friendships and a stronger sense of local community spirit.
- 6 Researchers are exploring the fascinating link between 'dream recall' and daily creativity.**
It appears that people who remember their dreams more often tend to exhibit higher levels of creative thinking and problem-solving during their waking hours.
- 7 The joy of 'upcycling old furniture' is captivating many, turning forgotten pieces into cherished treasures.**
This eco-friendly hobby allows individuals to breathe new life into vintage items, adding character and sustainability to their homes with a personal touch.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying on clothes in a shop, just to see how they really look?

ANSWER: ...POSING IN FRONT OF THE CHANGING ROOM MIRROR, TRYING OUT DIFFERENT ANGLES!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'word' or 'phrase' that we always mispronounce, even though we know the correct way?

ANSWER: ...LIKE 'ESPRESSO' INSTEAD OF 'EXPRESSO', OR 'NUCLEAR' INSTEAD OF 'NUCLAR'!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you discover a 'hidden gem' of a local shop or cafe that you just can't believe you hadn't noticed before?

What's your favourite unexpected local discovery, and what makes it so special?

- We all have those little 'comfort sounds' that instantly make us feel relaxed and at home, don't we?

What's a sound that instantly makes you feel cosy, perhaps the kettle boiling, or rain on the window?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of ferrets is actually called a 'business'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that a chameleon's tongue is so long and fast that it can catch prey mid-air from up to three metres away?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£59 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£59 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still perfectly edible.
- The world's largest snowflake on record was 15 inches wide and 8 inches thick, reported in Montana, USA, in 1887.
- The 'richest' soil on Earth is found in the Amazon rainforest, where a single teaspoon can contain more organisms than there are people on Earth.
- The first successful photograph of a human being was taken in 1838 by Louis Daguerre, though the person was simply having their shoes shined.
- The 'Punt' in a wine bottle refers to the indentation at the bottom, which adds strength and makes pouring easier.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, defined as 1/100th of a second, particularly in physics.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Cracking your knuckles does not cause arthritis; the sound is simply gas bubbles bursting in the synovial fluid of your joints.

On this day

Day 179 of the year, 186 days left in 2026. Today International LGBTQ Pride Day, marking the anniversary of Stonewall riots.; Christian feast day: Basilides and Potamiana; Christian feast day: Irenaeus of Lyon (Western Christianity); Christian feast day: Heimerad. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1959 — Clint Boon, English singer and keyboard player
- 1948 — Deborah Moggach, English author and screenwriter
- 1966 — Bobby Bare Jr., American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1945 — Ken Buchanan, Scottish boxer (died 2023)
- 1971 — Aileen Quinn, American actress and singer
- 1970 — Mike White, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1986 — Kellie Pickler, American singer-songwriter
- 1951 — Lalla Ward, English actress and author

THE DAY TODAY

- 2001 — Slobodan Milošević is extradited to the ICTY in The Hague to stand trial.
- 1976 — The Angolan court sentences US and UK mercenaries to death sentences and prison terms in the Luanda Trial.
- 1936 — The Japanese puppet state of Mengjiang is formed in northern China.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1948 — Boxer Dick Turpin beats Vince Hawkins at Villa Park in Birmingham to become the first black British boxing champion in the modern era.
- 1978 — The United States Supreme Court, in Regents of the University of California v. Bakke bars quota systems in college admissions.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1945 — Poland's Soviet-allied Provisional Government of National Unity is formed over a month after V-E Day.
- 1969 — Stonewall riots begin in New York City, marking the start of the Gay Rights Movement.

- 1942 — World War II: Nazi Germany starts its strategic summer offensive against the Soviet Union, codenamed Case Blue.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 180 of the year, 185 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Cassius of Narni; Christian feast day: Hemma of Gurk; Christian feast day: Mary, mother of John Mark; Christian feast day: Feast of Saints Peter and Paul (Western Christianity), and its related observances: Haro Wine Festival (Haro, La Rioja). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1944 — Gary Busey, American actor
- 1953 — Don Dokken, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1950 — Don Moen, American singer and songwriter
- 1991 — Addison Timlin, American actress
- 1970 — Emily Skinner, American actress and singer
- 1993 — Oliver Tree, American singer-songwriter (died 2026)
- 1943 — Little Eva, American singer (died 2003)
- 1965 — Paul Jarvis, English cricketer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1987 — Vincent van Gogh's painting, the Le Pont de Trinquetaille, is bought for \$20.4 million at an auction in London, England.
- 1950 — Korean War: U.S. President Harry S. Truman authorizes a sea blockade of Korea.
- 1975 — Pope Paul VI ordains some 350 priests in St. Peter's Square in the largest ordination in history

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2007 — Apple Inc. releases its first mobile phone, the iPhone.
- 2006 — Hamdan v. Rumsfeld: The U.S. Supreme Court rules that President George W. Bush's plan to try Guantanamo Bay detainees in military tribunals violates U.S. and international law.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
		18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)